

The 2025 *One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBA)* makes numerous amendments to the *Higher Education Act of 1965*, as amended (*HEA*), some of which became effective upon enactment of *OBBA* while others will become effective on July 1, 2026, and beyond. To ensure that the U.S. Department of Education (ED) can implement those provisions that are effective now or will become effective on July 1, 2026, ED is drafting presentations and documents in advance of publication of a final rule on these topics. These presentations and documents are intended to ensure that vendors, servicers, partners and stakeholders have the requisite time to prepare for the implementation of the *OBBA*. However, the information is subject to change depending upon ED's rulemaking process. ED has not prejudged the outcome of that negotiated rulemaking process. This information provides a structure for vendors, servicers, partners and stakeholders to begin building these systems, but it does not impair, prevent, or control policy decisions that may be made by ED. The information is preliminary, and ED, including its vendors and servicers, will not launch any new systems or make final system changes that are public facing until ED publishes a final rule on these topics. ED will provide additional information if any changes are made during the rulemaking process.

Volume 7

COD XML

Examples

COMMON ORIGATION AND DISBURSEMENT
2026 – 2027 Technical Reference

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Section 1

System Generated XML Testing Instructions

System Generated XML Testing Instructions

Volume 7 of the COD Technical Reference is intended for schools and software providers to validate XML schema using COD system generated response files.

The examples included in the subsequent sections are intended to validate that a system can successfully import COD system generated XML files. They are not intended to validate any business rule processing.

Users intending to validate the schema may have to modify the content of the examples, depending on the software provider. For example, you may have to modify the <OPEID> value in order to import the sample COD system generated XML response file. Specific changes may vary by software provider.

Note: the XML examples included in this, and other volumes of the COD Technical Reference are intended for reference only. All development should be done using the actual published schema available on the Knowledge Center: (<https://fsapartners.ed.gov/knowledge-center/library/cod-xml-schema/2025-11-25/cod-common-record-xml-schema-version-50d>)

Section 2

COD Common Record Input and Response Examples

The Common Origination and Disbursement Process utilizes one single record across programs for both originations and disbursements. Users utilize a Common Record — one that uses common data elements, definitions, edits, and structure for Grants and Direct Loans. Although the record has the same layout for all programs, not all data elements are required for each transmission. This new record layout relies on a technology called the eXtensible Markup Language, or XML.

This section provides examples of some of the COD Response Documents. For additional information regarding business rules, please refer to Volume 2, Section 1: Implementation Guide. For additional information regarding XML and the Common Record, please refer to Volume 1, Section 3: COD Overview of this technical reference.

COD Schema 5.0d Common Record

In these examples you will find an example of a common record input file containing records for two students that collectively have an award of each program type:

- Common Record Input Example
- Common Record Direct Loan Input Example

Please note that these examples are to be used as informational purposes only, any developmental use should reference the posted schema.

COD Schema 5.0d Response Documents

For all Common Records received and processed by the COD System, the COD System returns a Response document indicating the processing results, including any rejected data elements and reason for the rejection.

Please refer to the following examples:

- Pell Grant, TEACH Grant and Direct Loan with Warning Edit Response
- Pell Origination and Disbursement Response
- Pell award correction response
- Pell award reject response
- SSN Date of Birth Reject Response
- Direct PLUS Loan Common Record Response
- Direct Loan with Anticipated Disbursements and Warning Edits Response
- Direct Loan Correction Response
- Direct Loan Counseling
- Direct Loan Denied Credit Decision Response

- Direct Loan Web Origination and Disbursement Response
- Direct PLUS Loan Web Origination and Disbursement Response
- TEACH Grant Web Origination and Disbursement Response
- Booking Notification Response
- Payment to Servicer Response
- DL Sub/Unsub Unlinked MPN Response
- DL Unsub Linked MPN Response
- DL Grad PLUS Linked MPN Response
- DL Grad PLUS Unlinked MPN Response
- DL Grad PLUS Application Response
- DL Parent PLUS Linked MPN Response
- DL Parent PLUS Unlinked MPN Response
- DL Parent PLUS Application Response
- DL Sub Linked MPN Response
- Credit Status Response
- Subsidized Usage Change Response
- Entrance Counseling Acknowledgement
- PLUS Application Response for a Borrower with Accepted Credit
- TEACH Grant Initial and Subsequent Counseling Response
- TEACH Grant Exit Counseling Response
- TEACH Grant Counseling Response
- Negative Disbursement Response
- Origination Fee Response
- Informed Borrower Response
- Linked Agreement Acknowledgement
- Unlinked Agreement Acknowledgement